## Seeking Asylum

By July 2, 2013, WikiLeaks representative Sarah Harrison, working on Snowden's behalf, had applied for asylum for Snowden in 21 countries.[4] These countries included Austria, Brazil, China, Cuba, Finland, France, Germany, India, Ireland, Italy, the Netherlands, Nicaragua, Norway, Poland, Spain, Switzerland, and Venezuela. None accepted his application. Snowden had earlier made asylum requests to Iceland, Ecuador, and Russia.

In Iceland, Snowden's first choice for asylum, lawmakers proposed a new law to grant him citizenship. But the country said it could consider his request only if he were physically in the country or its embassy. Ecuador had a similar physical requirement. Ecuadorian President Rafael Correa also stated that US Vice President Joe Biden had asked Correa to reject Snowden's

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Believing the United States had put pressure on world leaders such as Ecuador's Correa, Snowden lashed out at the Obama administration for blocking his efforts and for canceling his passport. "These are the old, bad tools of political aggression," he said in a statement issued by WikiLeaks on July 1, 2013. "Their purpose is to frighten, not me, but those who would come after me. I am unbowed in my convictions."[5]

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